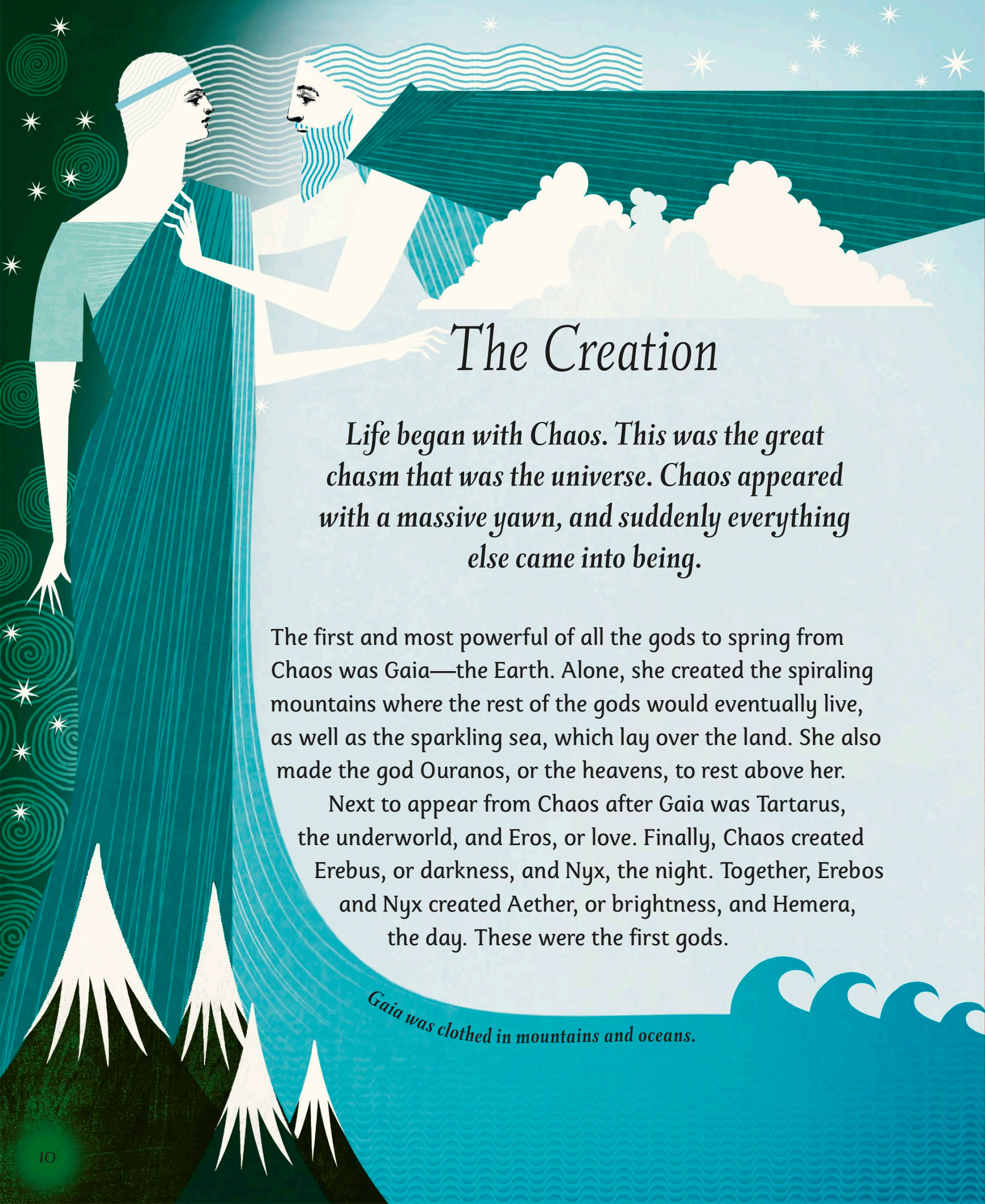




The Creation

Life began with Chaos. This was the great chasm that was the universe. Chaos appeared with a massive yawn, and suddenly everything else came into being.

The first and most powerful of all the gods to spring from Chaos was Gaia—the Earth. Alone, she created the spiraling mountains where the rest of the gods would eventually live, as well as the sparkling sea, which lay over the land. She also made the god Ouranos, or the heavens, to rest above her.

Next to appear from Chaos after Gaia was Tartarus, the underworld, and Eros, or love. Finally, Chaos created Erebus, or darkness, and Nyx, the night. Together, Erebus and Nyx created Aether, or brightness, and Hemera, the day. These were the first gods.

Gaia was clothed in mountains and oceans.